

Appealing a Special Needs Assistance for Seniors decision

Alberta | Special Needs Assistance for Seniors | Built Revised 3 October 2026

About this packet

This is a fillable working copy built by The Alberta Disability System Breakdown. It opens and fills on any phone, tablet or computer. **It is NOT an official Government of Alberta form.**

Steps 1 and 2 are letters you write yourself. Step 3 uses the program's own Notice of Appeal form, which is not published online; the program mails it to you after Step 2.

This packet is not legal advice. It is a way to put your own appeal in writing.

This packet helps you appeal a Special Needs Assistance for Seniors decision.

The program uses three steps. You must do them in order. Each step is a separate letter.

Step 3 uses a form called a Notice of Appeal. You cannot download it. The program mails it to you only after you finish Step 2. So Steps 1 and 2 are where you build your case.

Fill in what you can. Leave the rest blank. A short letter still counts.

What the rules say

The rule is section 9 of the Seniors Benefit Act General Regulation, AR 213/94.

You can appeal two things: whether you qualify, and how much you were paid.

The appeal goes in writing to the Minister.

The Minister may send your appeal to a panel of up to three people. The word is *may*, not *must*.

Back pay. The regulation has an 11-month limit on back pay (section 7) and lets a panel go past it (section 9(2)(d)). Both are written for the monthly Alberta Seniors Benefit. Neither one names Special Needs Assistance. What the program's own page says is that it can accept a receipt for something bought up to 12 months before your claim reached them (program page, as read on 3 October 2026). If yours is older than that, ask anyway, in writing, and ask them to answer in writing.

The panel's decision is final. The rule is section 9(4).

There is also section 8.2. It lets the Minister pay up to \$5,000 for a senior who cannot meet the necessities of life. The regulation says \$5,000 in each year. The program page calls it one-time. The regulation also says you must have been an Alberta resident for at least 3 months before you apply, in section 3(1)(b). The program page only says you must be an Alberta resident, with no time on it. If you moved here recently, apply anyway and say how long you have lived in Alberta. If this may apply to you, name section 8.2 in your letter.

Why this packet exists

Step 3 uses a form the program will not publish. It is mailed to you only after Step 2 is finished. That is why this packet puts your whole case in writing at Steps 1 and 2. Your written appeal stands on its own.

If you need help

Alberta Supports Contact Centre: 1-877-644-9992. Monday to Friday, 7:30 am to 8 pm. Fax: 780-422-5954.

Step 1. Letter of appeal

Send this to: Director, Seniors Financial Assistance, Special Needs Assistance for Seniors, PO Box 3100, Edmonton, Alberta T5J 4W3. Fax: 780-422-5954. Or upload it through Submit documents online at seniors.alberta.ca/submit-documents.

YOUR FULL NAME

Up to 70 characters

YOUR CLIENT OR FILE NUMBER, IF YOU HAVE ONE

Up to 30 characters

How you were told

How you were told matters. The program says it will send you a letter with the decision, the law it was made under, the evidence it looked at, and the reasons. If you were told by phone and nothing came in the mail, say so. That is part of your appeal.

☐ I got the decision in writing.

☐ I was told by phone or in person. Nothing came in writing.

DATE ON THE LETTER, OR THE DATE YOU WERE TOLD

Up to 20 characters

WHO TOLD YOU, BY NAME OR JOB TITLE

Up to 60 characters

WHAT THE DECISION SAID

Up to 500 characters

WHAT YOU ASKED THE PROGRAM TO PAY FOR

Up to 400 characters

WHY YOU DISAGREE

Up to 1200 characters

WHAT THIS DECISION COSTS YOU

Up to 600 characters

WHAT YOU ARE ATTACHING

Up to 400 characters

___ I am asking the director to consider section 8.2, the necessities benefit, up to \$5,000.
If you need more room, use a separate sheet. Put your name at the top of it.

SIGNATURE (TYPE YOUR NAME) DATE YOU SIGNED DATE YOU SENT THIS

Up to 70 characters

Up to 20 characters

Up to 20 characters

Write the date you send this. The date you send matters more than the date you sign.

What you should get back

The program says its letter will tell you four things: the decision, the law it was made under, the evidence it looked at, and the reasons.

If any of those four are missing, say so in Step 2. Keep this page.

Step 2. Request a final review

Send this to: Assistant Deputy Minister, Seniors Division, PO Box 3100, Edmonton, Alberta T5J 4W3. Fax: 780-422-5954. Or upload it through Submit documents online at seniors.alberta.ca/submit-documents.

YOUR FULL NAME

DATE OF THE DIRECTOR'S DECISION

Up to 70 characters

Up to 20 characters

Check what the Step 1 letter gave you

Tick what the Step 1 letter gave you. If no letter ever came, tick the last box instead and say so in your own words below. A missing letter is a reason to appeal on its own.

- ☐ I was given the decision itself
- ☐ I was given the law it was decided under
- ☐ I was given the evidence that was considered
- ☐ I was given the reasons for the decision
- ☐ No letter ever came

WHAT IS STILL UNRESOLVED

Up to 1000 characters

ANYTHING NEW SINCE STEP 1

Up to 800 characters

WHAT YOU WANT TO HAPPEN

Up to 500 characters

If you need more room, use a separate sheet. Put your name at the top of it.

SIGNATURE (TYPE YOUR NAME)

DATE YOU SIGNED

DATE YOU SENT THIS

Up to 70 characters

Up to 20 characters

Up to 20 characters

Step 3. Your record, and what to ask the panel

Keep dates here. If the Notice of Appeal form does not arrive, these dates are your proof.

DATE YOU SENT THE FINAL REVIEW

Up to 20 characters

DATE THE ANSWER CAME BACK

Up to 20 characters

DATE THE NOTICE OF APPEAL FORM CAME

Up to 20 characters

PHONE AND MAIL LOG (DATE, WHO YOU SPOKE TO, WHAT THEY SAID)

Up to 1200 characters

What to put on the Notice of Appeal when it comes

Ask for the appeal to go to a panel. Section 9(2) lets the Minister send it there.

If you were paid late, or paid for less time than you should have been, ask the panel to pay you back to the date you first qualified. Section 9(2)(d) writes the panel's back-pay power for the monthly Alberta Seniors Benefit, so it may not cover Special Needs Assistance. Ask anyway, and ask for the answer in writing.

Name section 8.2 if you cannot meet the necessities of life.

Attach this packet. It is your written appeal already.

If you believe a particular person handled your file wrongly, write that in your own words in the box below. Keep it to what you saw or were told, and give dates. Do not guess at why.

IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Up to 1200 characters

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